

By STEVE WESTON

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EL PASO — Any resemblance between baseball and what happened here yesterday was purely accidental.

Arizona and Texas-El Paso divided a Western Athletic Conference doubleheader, UA winning the first game, 6-5, UTEP the second, 8-7.

The second-game loss was a setback for coach Frank Sancet's Wildcats (28-8) in the WAC southern division race. UA, 2-1 in league play, needed a sweep of the three-game series.

But the elements and the inability of Sancet's No. 2 and No. 3 pitchers to get people out cost the Wildcats an important victory. It almost cost them two losses.

A violent windstorm played havoc with everything hit into the air—and some of the routine grounders to the infield were even windblown.

Fourteen doubles were caromed around Dudley Field and off its fences. And only a couple were honest two-base blows.

The pique of the moment was captured by UTEP centerfielder Brian Harper in the top of the fourth inning of the second game.

After a long, long chase of a ball hit by UA's Steve Mikulic, the wind blew it just past Harper's glove for a double. In frustration, Harper threw his glove against the fence.

In the opener, UA starter Larry Dierks lasted through three and a half batters. He walked three and left with a partial count on another — who also walked.

But Mickey O'Hara picked up for Dierks and went all the way for his fifth win.

He had some shaky moments and almost lost it in the bottom of the ninth. UTEP scored twice and had the bases loaded when pitcher Larry Smith struck out.

Normally, a pitcher isn't sent to the plate to bat in that kind of situation.

And UTEP coach Andy Cohen chewed out his official scorer-assistant coach for not letting him (Cohen) know it was the bottom of the ninth. In that case, Cohen argued, he would not have let Smith bat.

Mikulic was UA's top hitter in the opener with three hits and two RBIs.

UA starter Bryan Shields didn't have any luck in the second contest—though his teammates staked him to a four-run lead in the top of the first on Jay Ray Rokey's two-run double and a single by Jim Williams which also plated a pair of runs.

Shields got the first two batters he faced, then was laced with two singles, a double and a home run by Rick Butler, and that tied it.

UA fought from behind the rest of the gusty day, and lost it in a strange way in the bottom of the sixth.

Bob Prokopowicz scored the winner for the Miners, coming in from third when batter Terry Shimp swung for a strike on a wild pitch and the ball eluded Rokey.

It was, in all, an incredible day—and a definite setback for the National Pastime.

There were 42 hits, 14 of them doubles, and 39 runners were left on base.

## 'Lopes lift mark--26-3

Grand Canyon College upped its season record to 26-3 with a doubleheader sweep over Southern Utah yesterday, winning 3-2 and 10-4.

Jim Montoya tossed a four-hitter and struckout six in the opener, winning his fourth of the season without a loss. Jim Clark slapped three Grand Canyon hits while Craig Green had two. Each had a run batted in.

In the nightcap, three Canyon pitchers teamed for a